FRAM SCHOOL

CAMBRIDGE International Education

Cambridge International School

FRAM Primary School

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NAVIGATE YOUR OWN JOURNEYS OF LEARNING AND SELF-DISCOVERY IN AN EXCITING FUTURE

FRAM DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION POLICY

1. Introduction and Purpose

At FRAM *[International]* School, we are committed to fostering a welcoming, respectful, and inclusive community where every individual is valued. Our Diversity and Inclusion Policy reflects our dedication to celebrating differences in culture, religion, gender, race, disability, and background, ensuring that all members of our school community feel safe, respected, and empowered to succeed.

Our commitment to Diversity and Inclusion is integral to fulfilling our school's mission of fostering creativity, critical thinking, and collaboration within a respectful, supportive environment. We believe that embracing our differences enriches our community and prepares students to thrive in a diverse global society.

All members of the school community are responsible for upholding these principles, ensuring that FRAM [International] School remains a safe, respectful, and inclusive place for everyone.

2. Alignment to School Values and Commitment

Our core values - ***kindness, respect, fairness, awareness, and leadership*** - are the foundation of our approach to diversity and inclusion. We believe that embracing and respecting individual differences enriches our educational community and promotes social cohesion.

We are committed to:

- Ensuring equal access to all educational opportunities and resources.
- Challenging discrimination, prejudice, and stereotypes proactively.
- Celebrating cultural, religious, and linguistic diversity within our community.
- Supporting students and staff from varied backgrounds to develop confidence, resilience, and a positive identity.
- Promoting an environment where all voices are heard and valued.

3. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the school community, including:

- Students across all year groups, from primary to future secondary and high school levels.
- School staff, including teachers, administrators, support staff, and contractors.
- Parents, guardians, visitors, and volunteers participating in school activities.
- External collaborators and community partners involved in school events and initiatives.

It covers:

- Curriculum content, teaching methods, and inclusive pedagogy.
- Classroom interactions, student and staff relationships.
- School activities, celebrations, extracurricular endeavors.
- Recruitment, appointment, training, and development of staff.
- School communications, marketing, and engagement with the wider community.
- Complaint and reporting procedures relating to discrimination or exclusion.
- Implementation of measures to promote a culture of inclusion, mutual respect, and cultural sensitivity.

4. Legal and Ethical Framework

This policy aligns with both Romanian legislation and international commitments designed to promote equality and fight discrimination, including:

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Romanian Legislation:

- Law No. 21/2017 on Education:
  Ensures equal access to education, prohibits discrimination, and calls for inclusive educational practices.
  Example: The school ensures that cultural diversity is reflected in the curriculum.
- Law No. 193/2000 on "Combating Discrimination":
  Prohibits discrimination based on race, ethnicity, religion, gender, age, disability, sexual orientation, etc.
  Example: The school investigates and addresses reports of discriminatory behavior promptly.
- Government Decision No. 123/2014:
  Supports inclusion of students with special educational needs through tailored support and resources.
- Law No. 215/2009 on the Protection of Children's Rights:
  Mandates safeguarding, welfare, and protection from abuse and discrimination.

International and Regional Principles:

- UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC):
  Guarantees children's right to education respecting their cultural identity and protection from discrimination.
- European Convention on Human Rights (ECHR):
  Protects fundamental rights, including non-discrimination and access to education.
- UNESCO and UNICEF Guidelines:
  Advocate for equitable, inclusive, and quality education accessible for all children regardless of background.

Application in the School:

- The school actively complies with Romanian laws and international standards to promote equality and prevent discrimination.

- Staff receive ongoing training on legal obligations related to diversity, rights, and safeguarding.
- Clear procedures are established for reporting and investigating cases of discrimination, hate speech, or harassment, ensuring a safe environment.

Example:
If a student faces religious or racial discrimination, the school investigates promptly, provides support, and takes disciplinary action in accordance with Romanian law and school policies.

5. Principles and Practice

Respect for Cultural and Religious Differences
- The school recognizes major religions and cultural practices within our diverse student body, including Christianity, Islam, Hinduism, atheism, and others.
- Events and holidays are celebrated inclusively, respecting all beliefs.
- Curricula and activities reflect multicultural perspectives.

Equal Opportunities
- All students and staff are provided access to all aspects of school life without bias.
- Activities, leadership roles, and resources are allocated equitably.

Respect and Fairness
- Discriminatory language, behaviors, and attitudes are actively challenged.
- Respectful communication and interactions are promoted through policies, curricula, and school culture.

Inclusion in Curriculum and School Life
- Teaching materials and classroom discussions will represent diverse cultural, religious, and social perspectives.
- Students are encouraged to share their cultural backgrounds and experiences.

6. Implementation and Responsibilities

Leadership:

- The School Leadership Team (SLT) will oversee the implementation of this policy, ensuring it is embedded in all school operations, curriculum, and culture.
- Regular training and development sessions will be provided to staff to promote cultural awareness, anti-discrimination practices, and inclusive pedagogy.

Staff:

- All staff are responsible for fostering an inclusive classroom environment.
- They will address discriminatory behaviors swiftly and appropriately.
- They will participate in ongoing training and professional development related to diversity and inclusion.

Students:

- Students are expected to demonstrate respectful behavior towards peers and staff.
- They will participate in activities promoting inclusivity, understanding, and acceptance.
- Students are encouraged to report any concerns of discrimination or exclusion to trusted adults or through established channels.

Parents and Guardians:

- They are vital partners in promoting the values of diversity and inclusion.
- The school encourages open dialogue about cultural issues and expects parental support in reinforcing respectful behaviors at home.
- Parents will be informed of policies and procedures related to inclusion and reporting mechanisms.

Community and Collaboration:

- The school will seek partnerships with community organizations to promote diversity and intercultural understanding.

7. Monitoring, Review, and Evaluation

- The effectiveness of this policy will be reviewed annually, involving feedback from students, staff, parents, and external stakeholders.
- Discrimination or inclusion incidents will be logged and analyzed to identify trends and inform improvements.
- The school will perform regular audits of curriculum content, school environment, and staff training programs to ensure inclusiveness.

- Modifications to the policy will be made as needed to adapt to changing demographics and best practices.

8. Supporting a Culture of Inclusion

Our goal is for FRAM [International] School to be an exemplary environment where diversity is celebrated, and every student feels valued. We will:

- Celebrate cultural, religious, and national events to foster understanding.
- Incorporate intercultural competency into the curriculum.
- Provide targeted support for vulnerable or minority groups.
- Promote open dialogue to challenge stereotypes and prejudice.

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Annex 1 to the Diversity and Inclusion Policy: Legal and Regulatory Compliance

This annex highlights the legal obligations and international commitments that underpin our school's Diversity and Inclusion Policy, ensuring full compliance with Romanian legislation and recognition of international standards promoting equality and non-discrimination.

1. Romanian Legislation

a. Law No. 21/2017 on Education

- Ensures that every student has equal access to quality education regardless of their cultural, religious, or socio-economic background.
- Reaffirms the importance of integrating cultural diversity into the curriculum, promoting respect for different traditions and perspectives.

  Application: The school reflects this by designing curricula that include diverse cultural content and celebrating multicultural events.

b. Law No. 193/2000 on "Combatting Discrimination"

- Prohibits any form of discrimination based on race, ethnicity, religion, gender, age, disability, sexual orientation, and other protected grounds.
- Places an obligation on the school to investigate and resolve reports of discriminatory conduct swiftly and effectively.

  Application: The school investigates all complaints and applies disciplinary or corrective measures consistent with legal standards.

c. Government Decision No. 123/2014

- Supports the inclusion of students with special educational needs (SEN) by providing tailored support and necessary resources.
- Ensures that all students, regardless of abilities, have access to appropriate educational opportunities.

Application: The school provides individualized support plans, and assistive technologies for students with SEN.

d. Law No. 215/2009 on the Protection of Children's Rights

- Mandates safeguarding children's safety, emphasizing their right to protection from all forms of discrimination, abuse, and neglect within educational environments.

  Application: The school maintains safeguarding policies and conducts staff training to uphold children's rights.

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2. International and Regional Principles

a. UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC)

- Recognizes children's right to education respecting their cultural identities and providing protection against discrimination.

  Application: The school respects and promotes each child's cultural identity through inclusive practices, policies, and curriculum content.

b. European Convention on Human Rights (ECHR)

- Ensures the fundamental rights of every individual, including the right to education and freedom from discrimination.

  Application: The school upholds these rights by fostering an environment free from discrimination and biased attitudes.

c. UNESCO and UNICEF Guidelines

- Advocate for equitable, inclusive, and high-quality education for all children, emphasizing respect for diversity and strong anti-discrimination measures.

  Application: The school adopts best practices aligned with these guidelines, promoting equitable participation and celebrating diversity.

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3. Implementation and Monitoring

The school commits to:

- Regularly review and update policies and practices in line with evolving legal and international standards.
- Conduct staff training to ensure full understanding and compliance with these laws and principles.
- Maintain transparent procedures for reporting, investigating, and resolving discrimination or exclusion cases.
- Document relevant incidents and measures taken ensuring accountability and continuous improvement.

Document outlined by: Marieluise Knobloch Issued on: 22.07.2025			
Reviewed by			
Approved by	SLT	Next Review	01-20.03.2026